

Configuration files deleted, data recovery, incomplete setup...

Get solutions to all your technical queries here

Partition woes

I had installed openSUSE 12.1, which I was using along with Windows 7 but now I want to remove that. So I formatted its partition using Windows. On rebooting my system it didn't start. It wasn't booting so I have to install it again (openSUSE). Please tell me how to uninstall it.

Rishab Shukla

This is one of the most common problems one faces after formatting a Linux partition. The bootloader, which in your case is GRUB, still resides in the MBR, but all the configuration files were deleted when you formatted the Linux partition.

Make sure you have a Windows 7 System Repair Disc or Windows 7 Installation Disc handy before startup. To get rid of OpenSUSE, format the OpenSUSE partition (again) from inside Windows. Next, pop in the Windows 7 disc into the drive and select "Repair your computer" when prompted to do so. In the system recovery dialog that follows, select "Command Prompt". Inside command prompt type in the following commands `Bootrec.exe /FixBoot` and `Bootrec.exe /FixMBR`. Now exit the prompt and hit Restart. You should now be able to boot into Windows.

Graphic card for my mobo

My motherboard, Gigabyte GA-MA-785GM-US2H is based on AMD 785G Chipset & AMD Athlon X2 7850 Black Edition processor.

The board is ATI Hybrid Crossfire certified with onboard ATI Radeon HD 4200 512 MB. I want a discreet graphic card for my board to enhance my experience of HD movies and casual gaming.

Now since AMD claims that for this chipset I can only have an ATI Radeon graphic card which is ATI Hybrid crossfire certified, the only model that fits this crite-

ria is ATI Radeon HD 3450. This model is not currently available in the market (Lamington Road) as it has become older.

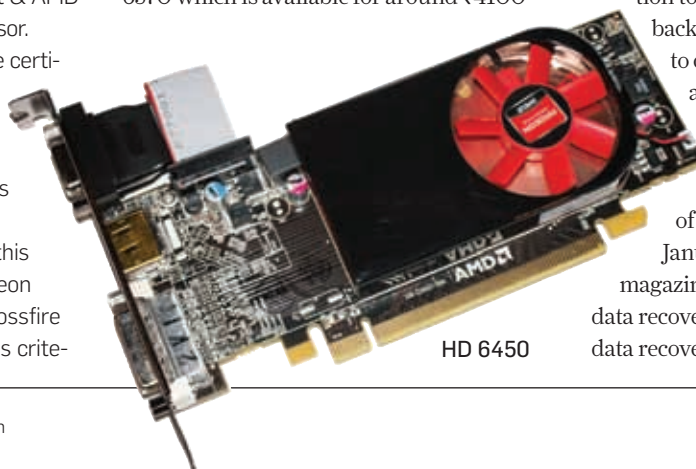
The other model now available is ATI Radeon HD 5450 for ₹2150.

I want to know whether it will support ATI Hybrid Crossfire with my motherboard.

I don't play games much. Currently I have *NFS Most Wanted* and *Burnout Paradise*. They felt slow with my onboard graphics so I stopped playing them. I want to play other NFS games or similar racing games later if 5450 can support them well, although I want it primarily for viewing HD movies. So is it sufficient for these tasks? You can recommend other Radeon models also.

Abhishek Bhikale

If you want to just play HD movies and game at moderate resolutions (say 1280x1024 and lower) then the HD 5450 is a decent card - better still is the HD 6450 (around ₹2800). However, if you plan to play future games which may require more power from your card you can go for HD 6570 which is available for around ₹4100



HD 6450

Ubuntu lost my data

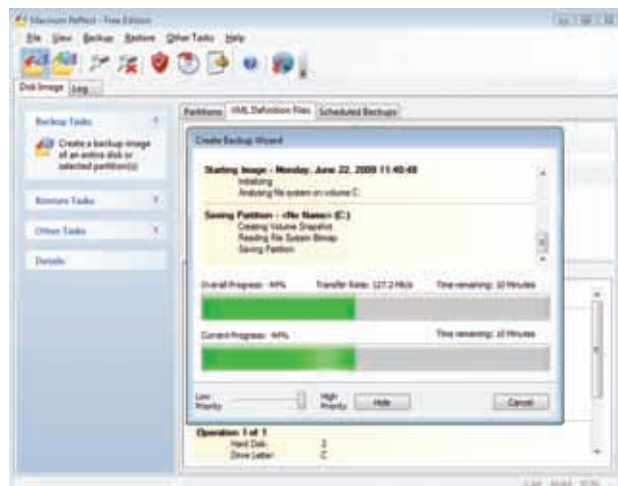
I had a problem while installing Ubuntu on my laptop with Windows 7 Home Basic OS (licensed version) using a CD.

It didn't ask for the partition drive. I heard that it would result in loss of the data and requires formatting.

Can you please suggest if there's any way to completely recover the lost data?

Any software which is freeware or open source, which does the job?

Sunil S



Macrium Reflect

Ubuntu has an option which installs it along side an existing operating system. It will create a new partition on your hard drive and install itself there, without disturbing the contents of the other operating system. On running the setup, you'll reach the installation type dialog, select 'Install Ubuntu alongside Windows 7'. Then select the size you want to allocate to the Ubuntu partition and you're good to go. You can even select a custom file system layout for your system.

In case you still don't trust the installation to work properly you can use a free backup utility called Macrium Reflect to create an image of your drive and save it on an external hard disk. You can use this image to restore the data you lose.

We have packed in a host of data recovery software in the January 2012 Alpha DVD. The magazine too carries Tips and Tricks on data recovery, which discusses how to use data recovery tools.